

As I
Was Saying

BOB INGRAM
SPORTS EDITOR

'Boy' and the Beast

A JOCKEY IN THE PERFORMANCE of his duties has to be an animal trainer, putting a 1000-pound horse through his paces just like the man in the circus ring does it with ferocious tigers and lions.

This slant was brought out in a post-Belmont Stakes interview of Willie Shoemaker who rode the winning Damascus.

Willie said he had trouble with Damascus at the start of the race. The colt was not settling down to the kind of a pace that Willie wanted.

At one point, however, fairly early in the race, Shoemaker got Damascus under control and got him to relax. "From then on I could do anything I wanted to with Damascus," said Willie.

It was remarkable co-ordination of horse and rider in the run down the stretch. With Willie moving his body in unison with the horse, it looked like they were rowing on the same team in a regatta.

They call them boys around a race track no matter how old the jockeys are. It's one business in which a boy instead of a man is called to do a job.

Getting Names in Story

ON A DOZEN OR MORE OCCASIONS at least I've heard Andy Cohen tell his favorite banquet story.

He was in a big league game and the announcer said, "Cohen batting for Fitzsimmons."

And a man with a bull horn voice up in the stands announces to the crowd: "And Flannagan is leaving the park."

Sports Illustrated this week gives a little different slant on it. In a story on John McGraw and the Giants, SI says the scene was at the Polo Grounds in New York and it was announced that Cohen was batting for Frank (Shanty) Hogan. And then a fellow stood up in the grandstand and yelled in a loud brogue, "And Callahan is going home."

Andy claims that it was a true experience but admits that there has been some liberty taken in names. Facts are the same but names have been changed, not especially to help the innocent.